Practical 5: Build the RetailPulse Sales Prompt Report

Related topic: Design a Cognos Prompt Report for Sales Analysis | Tool: IBM Cognos Analytics | Package: RetailPulse

Objective

Design a prompt page with value, date-range, and cascading prompts, and link each control to a report filter.

Materials Required

IBM Cognos Analytics access, the RetailPulse Region-Product Crosstab from Practical 4.

Step-by-Step Procedure

#	Action performed	Observation
1	Opened **RetailPulse Region-Product Crosstab** in the Report studio.	Single report page (Page1) with the crosstab.
2	Opened **Prompt pages** and inserted a new prompt page ahead of the crosstab page.	Prompt page created and ordered first.
3	Added a **Value prompt** (Parameter: Region) and a **Date range prompt** (Parameters: StartDate, EndDate).	Two controls placed on the prompt page.
4	Added a second **Value prompt** (Parameter: Store) and set **Cascade source = Region**.	Store list depends on the selected Region.
5	Added detail filters on the crosstab query: [Region] = ?Region?, [Sales Date] between ?StartDate? and ?EndDate?, [Store Name] in ?Store?.	Each control linked to its filter by parameter name.
6	Set defaults (Region = North, dates = current quarter, Store = All), added a **Finish** button, then ran end to end for North and South.	Defaults give a valid report; changing Region refreshes Store and results.

Output

Prompt page - default values (Region = North)

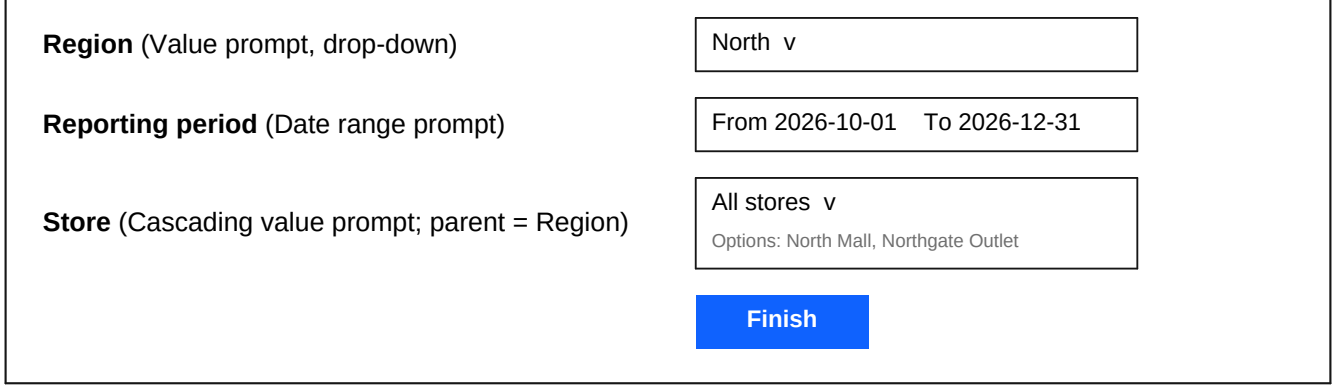

Fig 5.1: Prompt page with value, date-range and cascading Store prompts.

Result - Region = North, Q4 2026, Store = All

	Electronics		Apparel		Home		Grocery		Total	
Region	Sales	Qty	Sales	Qty	Sales	Qty	Sales	Qty	Sales	Qty
North	$69,519.42	325	$11,681.66	253	$11,383.59	146	$1,997.05	175	$94,581.72	899

Total Sales $94,581.72, Quantity 899 (matches the Practical 3 filtered total).

Prompt page - Region changed to South

Region (Value prompt, drop-down) — South v

Reporting period (Date range prompt) — From 2026-10-01 To 2026-12-31

Store (Cascading value prompt; parent = Region) — South Plaza v

Options: South Plaza, Southside Mart

Finish

Fig 5.2: Store list refreshed to South stores after Region changed.

Result - Region = South, Q4 2026, Store = South Plaza

	Electronics		Apparel		Home		Grocery		Total	
Region	Sales	Qty	Sales	Qty	Sales	Qty	Sales	Qty	Sales	Qty
South	$39,570.37	186	$8,425.82	186	$4,469.80	56	$2,072.53	176	$54,538.52	604

Total Sales $54,538.52, Quantity 604.

Expected Outcome Check

✓ Prompt page renders Region, date-range and Store controls correctly.
✓ Changing Region updates the Store list without error.
✓ Submitting returns a crosstab filtered to the chosen values.
✓ Default values produce a sensible report without changes.

Conclusion

A prompt page with value, date-range and cascading prompts was added in front of the crosstab, each control linked to a filter, and tested end to end for North and South.

Note: screens and figures are illustrative renderings built on a consistent sample RetailPulse dataset (report date 15 October 2026, current quarter Q4 2026: 1 Oct to 31 Dec).